PART 1: INTRODUCTION TO CORS

Chapter 1 begins by giving an overview of what CORS requests are and how they work. It then dives into CORS with an example that makes cross-origin requests to the Flickr API.

Chapter 2 introduces the `XMLHttpRequest` object, which can be used to make cross-origin requests. Next, it covers the `XDomainRequest` object, which is used to make CORS requests from Internet Explorer 8 and 9. Then it covers other places where CORS shows up, such as canvas images. Finally, it looks at how to make CORS requests using JQuery.

PART 2: IMPLEMENTING CORS

Chapter 3 switches gears to see how a server can be configured to support CORS. It takes a closer look at the role that the client code, the browser, and the server play in the lifecycle of a cross-origin request. It introduces the Access-Control-Allow-Origin header, which is how a server indicates that it allows cross-origin requests.

Chapter 4 introduces the concept of a *preflight request*, which is a small request that asks the server for permission to make the actual CORS request. It covers how the preflight request fits into the CORS lifecycle, and introduces a new set of HTTP headers for controlling the response.

Chapter 5 looks at how to include user credentials such as cookies on the request. It also shows how the server can grant permission to the client to read certain response headers.

The preceding chapters set the foundation for using CORS from the server. Chapter 6 expands on these ideas by providing a set of best practices for implementing CORS on your own server.

PART 3: CORS IN PRACTICE

Chapter 7 looks at how to debug CORS requests when something goes wrong. It introduces tools like the browser's debugging tools, Wireshark, and Fiddler, which can be used to monitor and diagnose CORS issues.

APPENDIXES

Appendix A provides a reference for all the CORS-related headers. Appendix B looks at how to set up Node.js and Express, which are used throughout the book for the sample code. Appendix C takes a closer look at CSRF issues, and how they relate to CORS. Appendix D looks at other cross-origin request techniques.

Online resources

This book provides a general introduction to CORS. If you'd like more information, here are a few resources you can turn to:

- The sample code for this book is hosted at GitHub (https://github.com/monsur/CORSinAction). You can either follow along with the book and type the code out, or download and run the code from here.